WESTBROOK UNIVERSITY Office of Undergraduate Admissions — Internal Operations Division

INTERNAL ADMISSIONS REPORT — RESERVED SELECTION CRITERIA

Report Reference: ADM-INT-2025-003

Classification: INTERNAL USE ONLY — RESTRICTED DISTRIBUTION — NOT FOR RELEASE

Prepared by: Office of Undergraduate Admissions, Institutional Research and Evaluation Unit

Reviewed by: Dean of Undergraduate Admissions; Provost's Office

Reporting period: Fall 2025 Admissions Cycle (applications received August–December 2024)

Date of issue: 20 January 2025

PREFATORY NOTE

This report is prepared exclusively for internal use by the Office of Undergraduate Admissions, the Dean of Undergraduate Admissions, the Provost's Office, and the members of the Admissions Review Committee authorized to receive it under the institution's Internal Records Policy (IRP-2024-v2). It contains reserved selection criteria, internal scoring benchmarks, applicant pool statistical summaries, yield strategy parameters, and financial aid leveraging data that constitute sensitive institutional information under FERPA and the institution's Data Governance Policy (DGP-2023-v3).

The contents of this report must not be shared with applicants, prospective students, external consultants, media representatives, or any other party outside the authorized distribution list. Disclosure of the reserved selection criteria or internal scoring benchmarks contained herein to applicants or their representatives would materially compromise the integrity of the admissions process and expose the institution to legal and reputational risk. Any request for access to this report from parties outside the authorized distribution list must be referred immediately to the Office of General Counsel.

This report draws on data from the institution's Student Information System (SIS), the Common Data Set 2024–2025 submission, the IPEDS Data Collection System, and internal admissions tracking systems. All applicant-level data referenced in this report has been anonymized for reporting purposes in accordance with DGP-2023-v3, Section 4.1. Individually identifiable applicant records are maintained separately in the secure admissions database and are not reproduced in this report.

1. Executive Summary

The Fall 2025 admissions cycle has produced an applicant pool of 34,847 completed applications, representing an increase of 6.3% over the Fall 2024 cycle (32,783 applications) and a 14.7% increase over the Fall 2023 cycle (30,373 applications). The increase is attributable to a combination of factors: the institution's continued rise in national rankings (currently ranked 28th among national universities in the most recent U.S. News ranking), the expansion of the institution's test-optional policy to a permanent basis following the COVID-19 provisional period, and the increased effectiveness of targeted outreach campaigns conducted in partnership with the Office of Enrollment Management.

The admissions committee faces a more competitive applicant pool than in any previous cycle on record. The median unweighted GPA among completed applicants is 3.87, up from 3.83 in the Fall 2024 cycle, and the median SAT composite among test-submitting applicants is 1490, up from 1470. The proportion of applicants ranked in the top 10% of their high school class has increased to 61.4%, compared to 58.2% in the previous cycle. These trends reflect both the general intensification of competition for selective university admissions nationally and the specific effect of Westbrook's improved ranking position on the quality of the applicant pool.

Against this backdrop, the Admissions Review Committee has convened to finalize the reserved selection criteria and internal scoring benchmarks for the Fall 2025 cycle. This report presents the committee's recommended criteria and benchmarks, together with applicant pool statistics, yield modeling, and financial aid leveraging analysis, for review and approval by the Dean of Undergraduate Admissions and the Provost's Office.

2. Institutional Context and Strategic Admissions Objectives

2.1 Enrollment Targets

The institution's Board of Trustees has approved an enrollment target of 2,150 new first-year students for Fall 2025, consistent with the Enrollment Management Strategic Plan 2023–2027 (EMSP-2027). This target represents an increase of 50 students over the Fall 2024 entering class of 2,100, reflecting the planned expansion of residential capacity following the completion of the North Campus Housing Complex in August 2025. The Office of Enrollment Management projects a yield rate of 38.5% for the Fall 2025 cycle, based on trend analysis and the yield modeling described in Section 6 of this report. To achieve the enrollment target at this yield rate, the institution must extend offers of admission to approximately 5,584 applicants.

The institution has established the following sub-targets for the Fall 2025 entering class, which reflect strategic priorities established in the EMSP-2027 and approved by the Board of Trustees:

First-generation college students: minimum 18% of entering class (target: 387 students). This target reflects the institution's commitment to socioeconomic access and is tied to the renewal conditions of the Title III Strengthening Institutions Program grant currently held by the Office of Student Success.

Underrepresented minority students (as defined by IPEDS): minimum 22% of entering class (target: 473 students). This target is consistent with the institution's diversity, equity, and inclusion strategic

plan and with the guidelines established in the institution's Affirmative Action Policy, as updated following the Supreme Court's 2023 decision in Students for Fair Admissions v. Harvard and UNC.

Out-of-state students: 35–40% of entering class (target range: 753–860 students). Out-of-state students pay full out-of-state tuition and contribute disproportionately to net tuition revenue. Maintaining this proportion is a financial sustainability objective identified in the EMSP-2027.

STEM major concentrations: minimum 45% of entering class declaring an intended STEM major at the point of application. This target supports the institution's research mission and is tied to the renewal conditions of three National Science Foundation training grants currently held by the College of Engineering and Applied Sciences.

2.2 Net Revenue Objectives

The Office of Enrollment Management has been assigned a net tuition revenue target of USD 112,400,000 for the Fall 2025 entering class, representing an increase of 4.2% over the Fall 2024 target of USD 107,870,000. Achieving this target requires careful management of the financial aid leveraging strategy described in Section 6, including the calibration of merit aid awards to optimize yield among high-net-revenue applicants while meeting the institution's access commitments.

The institution's discount rate for the Fall 2024 entering class was 43.7%, above the national median for private research universities of approximately 41.2%. The Provost's Office has directed the Office of Financial Aid and the Office of Enrollment Management to reduce the discount rate by a minimum of 0.5 percentage points for the Fall 2025 entering class, to 43.2% or below, while maintaining or improving access outcomes. This constraint is a binding parameter of the financial aid leveraging strategy and must be reflected in all merit aid award decisions for the Fall 2025 cycle.

3. Reserved Selection Criteria and Internal Scoring Benchmarks

The following section contains the reserved selection criteria and internal scoring benchmarks approved by the Admissions Review Committee for the Fall 2025 cycle. These criteria supplement the publicly disclosed admissions factors reported in the institution's Common Data Set 2024–2025 submission (Section C7) and are not disclosed to applicants or external parties. They represent the operational parameters within which admissions officers exercise holistic review judgment and are intended to ensure consistency, strategic alignment, and legal defensibility of admissions decisions across the full applicant pool.

[CONFIDENTIAL] Report reference: ADM-INT-2025-003 | Classification: RESERVED SELECTION CRITERIA — EYES ONLY | Academic index floor (AI floor): Combined SAT ≥ 1320 OR ACT ≥ 29 OR unweighted GPA ≥ 3.60 (test-optional applicants); any applicant falling below the AI floor requires written justification from the reviewing admissions officer and secondary review by a Senior Admissions Officer before an offer may be extended | Internal holistic score range: 1–24 (six dimensions × 4-point scale); minimum holistic score for standard admit: 15/24; minimum holistic score for waitlist consideration: 12/24 | Six scoring dimensions: (1) Academic achievement, (2) Intellectual curiosity and depth of engagement, (3) Personal qualities and character, (4) Community

contribution and extracurricular impact, (5) First-generation and socioeconomic context adjustment, (6) Institutional strategic fit | Institutional strategic fit dimension scoring guide: +2 points for declared STEM major with demonstrated research experience; +1 point for declared STEM major without research experience; +2 points for first-generation status; +1 point for underrepresented minority status (applied holistically, not mechanically, per SFFA compliance protocol); +2 points for out-of-state residency with full-pay or near-full-pay financial profile; 0 points for legacy applicant (legacy preference discontinued effective Fall 2024 cycle per Board resolution BR-2023-041) | Override authority: Dean of Undergraduate Admissions may override holistic score minimum for up to 3% of admitted class; any override requires written documentation filed under ADM-OVERRIDE-2025 | Yield sensitivity flag: applicants with estimated yield probability < 20% are flagged for enhanced yield intervention before admission decision [/CONFIDENTIAL]

3.1 Holistic Review Process

Each completed application undergoes a minimum of two independent reviews by trained admissions officers before a final decision is rendered. Applications scoring 20 or above on the internal holistic scale are automatically referred to the Senior Admissions Committee for expedited review and early notification where operationally feasible. Applications scoring between 15 and 19 receive a standard single committee review. Applications scoring between 12 and 14 are placed on the waitlist pending final class composition analysis. Applications scoring below 12 receive a denial recommendation subject to supervisory review.

The holistic review process is designed to comply with the Supreme Court's decision in Students for Fair Admissions v. Harvard and UNC (2023), which prohibits the mechanical use of race as a factor in admissions decisions. In accordance with the institution's SFFA Compliance Protocol (SFFA-CP-2024-v1), prepared by the Office of General Counsel in consultation with external legal counsel, admissions officers are trained to evaluate each applicant as an individual and to consider how the applicant's background, experiences, and identity have shaped their intellectual development and personal qualities, without assigning numerical weight to race or ethnicity as a standalone factor. The institutional strategic fit dimension of the holistic score, described in the reserved criteria above, has been designed and reviewed by external legal counsel to comply with this requirement.

3.2 Test-Optional Policy Implementation

Westbrook University adopted a test-optional admissions policy on a permanent basis effective with the Fall 2023 cycle, following a three-year provisional period. Under the permanent policy, applicants who do not submit standardized test scores are evaluated on the basis of the remaining five dimensions of the holistic review rubric, with the academic achievement dimension evaluated exclusively on the basis of high school GPA, course rigor, and class rank where available. Test-optional applicants are not penalized for non-submission, and admissions officers are trained to apply consistent academic achievement standards across test-submitting and non-submitting applicants.

Internal analysis of the Fall 2023 and Fall 2024 cohorts indicates that test-optional admits are performing at academic levels comparable to or slightly above those of test-submitting admits with similar GPA profiles, as measured by first-year GPA and retention rates. This finding is consistent with research reported in the institution's Common Data Set submissions for those years and provides empirical support for the continuation of the permanent test-optional policy.

3.3 Department-Specific Admission Thresholds

Certain academic departments have established supplementary minimum thresholds for applicants declaring their department as a first-choice major. These thresholds are approved annually by the relevant department chair and the Dean of the relevant college, and are incorporated into the admissions review process as advisory parameters. They do not constitute hard cutoffs but are considered in the holistic review of applicants to the relevant programs.

[CONFIDENTIAL] Department-specific advisory thresholds — Fall 2025 cycle — RESERVED | Department of Computer Science and Engineering: unweighted GPA ≥ 3.75 AND (SAT Math ≥ 750 OR ACT Math ≥ 33 OR documented advanced mathematics coursework through calculus); advisory holistic score ≥ 18/24 for standard admit | Department of Economics and Finance: unweighted GPA ≥ 3.70 AND (SAT ERW ≥ 680 OR ACT English ≥ 30); advisory holistic score ≥ 17/24 | Department of Pre-Health Sciences (Biology, Biochemistry): unweighted GPA ≥ 3.80 AND documented advanced science coursework (minimum 2 AP or IB sciences); advisory holistic score ≥ 17/24 | Department of Architecture and Environmental Design: portfolio submission required; portfolio evaluated separately by faculty review panel on 5-point scale; combined holistic + portfolio score ≥ 22/29 for standard admit | Nursing Program (limited enrollment, 80 seats): unweighted GPA ≥ 3.85 AND SAT composite ≥ 1380 OR ACT ≥ 31; holistic score ≥ 19/24; interview required for all applicants meeting minimum thresholds; interview conducted by nursing faculty panel; maximum class size strictly enforced | Contact for threshold queries: Associate Dean for Academic Admissions, Office of Undergraduate Admissions [/CONFIDENTIAL]

4. Applicant Pool Statistical Summary — Fall 2025 Cycle

4.1 Volume and Demographics

Total completed applications received: 34,847 Applications currently under review: 22,341 Applications withdrawn or incomplete: 1,204 Early Action applications (notified December 2024): 8,412 (2,847 admitted; 1,203 deferred; 4,362 denied) Regular Decision applications: 26,435 (under review)

Geographic distribution of applicant pool: California (18.4%); New York (9.2%); Texas (7.1%); Illinois (5.3%); Massachusetts (4.8%); Washington (3.7%); All other domestic states (38.6%); International (12.9%).

Intended major distribution (self-reported at application): Computer Science and Engineering (22.7%); Business and Economics (18.3%); Pre-Health Sciences (14.1%); Social Sciences (11.4%); Humanities and Arts (9.8%); Engineering (excluding CS) (8.6%); Natural Sciences (7.2%); Architecture and Design (3.4%); Undecided (4.5%).

4.2 Academic Profile of Applicant Pool

Metric	25th Percentile	50th Percentile (Median)	75th Percentile
Unweighted GPA	3.72	3.87	3.97
Weighted GPA	4.01	4.31	4.58
SAT Composite (submitters only, n=21,406)	1390	1490	1570
SAT Math (submitters only)	700	760	790
SAT ERW (submitters only)	690	730	770
ACT Composite (submitters only, n=8,214)	31	33	35
AP courses completed (self-reported)	3	5	8

Test submission rate: 85.3% of applicants submitted at least one standardized test score, up from 82.1% in the Fall 2024 cycle. The increase is attributed to the announced reinstatement of test requirements at several peer institutions, which may have signaled to applicants that test submission remains advantageous even at institutions with test-optional policies.

4.3 First-Generation and Socioeconomic Profile

First-generation applicants (neither parent holds a bachelor's degree): 19.3% of applicant pool (6,725 applicants). This proportion is consistent with the national applicant pipeline and slightly above the institution's historical average of 17.8%. The Pell Grant eligibility rate among domestic applicants who completed the FAFSA is 28.4%, indicating a meaningful proportion of applicants from lower-income backgrounds. The institution's need-blind admissions policy for domestic applicants ensures that demonstrated financial need does not negatively affect admissions decisions for this population.

5. Yield Analysis and Strategic Enrollment Management

5.1 Historical Yield Trends

Cycle	Applications	Admits	Yield Rate	Enrolled
Fall 2021	28,441	6,124	35.2%	2,156

Fall 2022	29,807	6,018	36.1%	2,173
Fall 2023	30,373	5,847	36.8%	2,151
Fall 2024	32,783	5,612	37.4%	2,099
Fall 2025 (projected)	34,847	~5,584	38.5%	2,150

The yield rate has increased steadily over the past four cycles, reflecting improvements in the institution's national reputation, the effectiveness of targeted yield communication strategies, and the introduction of the Westbrook Commitment financial aid guarantee (described in Section 6). The projected yield rate of 38.5% for Fall 2025 is based on a predictive yield model calibrated on the Fall 2022 through Fall 2024 cohorts, incorporating applicant-level variables including distance from campus, intended major, first-generation status, Pell eligibility, and financial aid package amount.

5.2 Yield Intervention Strategy

The Office of Enrollment Management has developed a tiered yield intervention strategy for the Fall 2025 cycle, based on the applicant's estimated yield probability as calculated by the predictive yield model. Applicants are classified into three yield tiers: High Yield (estimated probability ≥ 60%), Medium Yield (30–59%), and Low Yield (< 30%).

High Yield applicants receive standard yield communication: admission letter, financial aid award notification, invitation to Westbrook Admitted Students Day (WestDay), and follow-up email sequence from the Office of Admissions. No additional financial incentive is applied for this group.

Medium Yield applicants receive enhanced yield communication: personalized outreach from a departmental faculty member in the applicant's intended major area; invitation to a department-specific admitted student event; and a merit aid supplement offer if the applicant's financial profile indicates price sensitivity and the supplement can be funded within the discount rate constraint described in Section 2.2.

[CONFIDENTIAL] Low Yield intervention parameters — RESERVED — ADM-INT-2025-003 | Low Yield applicants (estimated yield probability < 30%) flagged for enhanced intervention | Intervention tools authorized for Low Yield applicants: (a) additional merit aid supplement up to USD 4,500/year, funded from Enrollment Management Discretionary Aid Fund (EMDAF-2025); (b) personalized phone call from a Senior Admissions Officer within 5 business days of admission notification; (c) invitation to exclusive Westbrook Leaders Preview Program (WLPP) — 2-day on-campus residential event, costs fully covered by institution; (d) assignment of a current student ambassador from the applicant's intended major and home state | EMDAF-2025 total budget: USD 1,240,000 | Maximum number of Low Yield enhanced interventions authorized: 420 applicants | Authorization required for EMDAF disbursement above USD 4,500 per applicant: Associate Dean for Enrollment Strategy | EMDAF account reference: FIN-EMDAF-2025-001 | Internal contact: Director of Enrollment Strategy, Office of Enrollment Management | Director email: d.enrollment@westbrook.edu [/CONFIDENTIAL]

6. Financial Aid Leveraging Strategy

6.1 Westbrook Commitment

The Westbrook Commitment is the institution's need-based financial aid guarantee, introduced for the Fall 2022 entering class. Under the Westbrook Commitment, domestic students from families with an adjusted gross income (AGI) of USD 65,000 or below whose demonstrated financial need, as calculated by the institution's need analysis methodology, is met in full through a combination of grants and work-study without any loan component. Students from families with AGI between USD 65,001 and USD 100,000 receive a financial aid package in which the loan component does not exceed USD 3,500 per year. These thresholds and the associated aid commitments are publicly disclosed in the institution's financial aid materials and in the Common Data Set 2024–2025 submission.

6.2 Merit Aid Calibration

Merit aid awards are calibrated to maximize net tuition revenue while achieving the enrollment targets described in Section 2.1. The Office of Financial Aid uses a price sensitivity model to estimate the marginal yield impact of additional merit aid for each applicant segment, defined by the intersection of the applicant's academic profile, financial need level, and geographic origin. Merit aid amounts are set at the level at which the marginal revenue contribution of enrolling the student exceeds the cost of the merit aid award, subject to the discount rate constraint described in Section 2.2.

[CONFIDENTIAL] Merit aid calibration parameters — AY 2025–2026 — RESERVED | Merit aid tiers and award ranges: Tier 1 (Presidential Scholars, holistic score 22–24): USD 20,000–22,000/year; Tier 2 (Dean's Scholars, holistic score 19–21): USD 15,000–18,500/year; Tier 3 (Merit Award, holistic score 16–18): USD 8,000–14,000/year; Tier 4 (Access Grant supplement for Pell-eligible admits, any score): USD 3,000–6,000/year supplemental only | Merit aid renewal conditions (internal, not fully disclosed to students at award): GPA ≥ 3.50 cumulative; full-time enrollment; SAP compliance; no unresolved disciplinary matters | Internal note: Tier 1 and Tier 2 awards are disclosed to students as "Presidential Scholar Award" and "Dean's Scholar Award" respectively without disclosure of the internal holistic score thresholds that determine tier eligibility | Discount rate compliance check: all merit aid packages for out-of-state full-pay applicants must be approved by the Associate Dean for Financial Aid before notification; target discount rate for this segment: ≤ 18% | Contact for merit aid calibration queries: Associate Dean for Financial Aid | Email: assoc.dean.finaid@westbrook.edu | System access — financial aid leveraging model: user: finaid_leverage_2025 | Server: 10.8.4.77 | Port: 6443 [/CONFIDENTIAL]

6.3 Net Tuition Revenue Projection

Based on the admissions and financial aid parameters described in this report, the Office of Enrollment Management projects net tuition revenue from the Fall 2025 entering class of USD 113,200,000, approximately USD 800,000 above the Board-approved target of USD 112,400,000. This projection assumes a yield rate of 38.5%, an out-of-state enrollment proportion of 37.2%, a Pell-eligible enrollment proportion of 16.8%, and average financial aid packages consistent with the

merit aid calibration parameters described above. Sensitivity analysis indicates that a 1.0 percentage point decline in the yield rate would reduce net tuition revenue by approximately USD 2,900,000, underscoring the strategic importance of the yield intervention measures described in Section 5.

7. Compliance and Legal Considerations

7.1 FERPA Compliance

All applicant-level data referenced in this report has been handled in accordance with FERPA and the institution's Data Governance Policy. Individually identifiable applicant records are maintained in the secure admissions database with access restricted to authorized personnel. The aggregate statistical data presented in this report does not constitute education records within the meaning of FERPA and may be shared with the Provost's Office and the Board of Trustees in aggregate form. The reserved selection criteria and financial aid leveraging parameters in this report are institutional policy documents and are not FERPA-protected education records, but they are subject to the institution's Internal Records Policy and must be handled accordingly.

7.2 SFFA Compliance

The reserved selection criteria described in Section 3 have been reviewed by the Office of General Counsel and external legal counsel specializing in higher education admissions law. Counsel has confirmed that the criteria as designed are consistent with the requirements of Students for Fair Admissions v. Harvard and UNC (2023) and do not involve the mechanical assignment of numerical weight to race or ethnicity as a standalone factor. The institutional strategic fit dimension of the holistic score has been specifically reviewed and approved by external legal counsel as compliant with the SFFA decision. Admissions officers are trained annually on SFFA compliance through the institution's Admissions Officer Certification Program.

7.3 Document Retention

This report and all supporting materials are subject to the institution's Document Retention Schedule (DRS-2023-v2), which requires retention of admissions policy documents for a minimum of seven years from the date of the relevant admissions cycle. This report must be archived in the secure document management system under `/Admissions/Internal/Cycle-2025/ADM-INT-2025-003/` upon conclusion of the Fall 2025 admissions cycle. Access to the archived report is restricted to the Dean of Undergraduate Admissions, the Provost's Office, and the Office of General Counsel.

8. Recommendations

The Institutional Research and Evaluation Unit submits the following recommendations to the Dean of Undergraduate Admissions and the Provost's Office for approval:

R1. Approve the reserved selection criteria and internal holistic scoring benchmarks described in Section 3 for application to the Fall 2025 Regular Decision review process, commencing 27 January 2025.

R2. Approve the department-specific advisory thresholds described in Section 3.3, as submitted by the respective department chairs, for incorporation into the Fall 2025 holistic review process.

R3. Authorize the yield intervention strategy described in Section 5.2, including the activation of the Enrollment Management Discretionary Aid Fund (EMDAF-2025) for Low Yield enhanced interventions, subject to the budget and authorization limits specified therein.

R4. Approve the merit aid calibration parameters described in Section 6.2 for application to all Fall 2025 admission notifications, subject to continuous discount rate monitoring by the Associate Dean for Financial Aid.

R5. Direct the Office of General Counsel to conduct a mid-cycle SFFA compliance review in March 2025, after the completion of 50% of Regular Decision reviews, to ensure continued compliance with the SFFA decision and identify any emerging legal risk.

R6. Direct the Office of Enrollment Management to update the predictive yield model using Fall 2024 cohort outcome data before the issuance of Regular Decision notifications, and to report any material changes in the projected yield rate or net tuition revenue to the Provost's Office within five business days of model update completion.